

THE MOVE

Shared point + modest signal + evidence + return of focus. -> "I recognise that part too, at least the timeline piece. How has that been showing up for you?" -> Professional: "We are dealing with the same constraint - unclear priorities. The ?

START HERE

I recognise that part. What has it been like on your side?

SAY THIS

Quick openers	"I recognise that part. What has it been like on your side?"
Low-key social	"I recognise that part. My version was not identical, but the uncertainty piece is familiar."
Professional	"We are probably facing the same constraint: unclear priorities."
Digital / async	"Same concern here: unclear ownership."
Disagreement / press...	"We disagree on the route, but I think we share the concern about avoiding rework."
Difference-protecting	"Different situations, clearly. I only meant the small uncertainty piece."

AVOID

- You would have to invent or exaggerate the similarity.
- They are sharing something painful and need listening more than affiliation.
- The similarity would minimise or flatten their experience.

REMEMBER

Make the bridge small enough to be true.